

INFOSYS 704 A1-D2 – Organisational Interview

Thank you for contributing to this INFOSYS 704 consulting assignment. This form should take approximately 10–12 minutes.

This interview focuses on how DPE New Zealand could manage serious and sustained underperformance across its franchise network. Publicly available DPE information describes ongoing franchise support through Franchise Consultants and Market Managers, while underperforming stores may require turnaround, refranchising, transfer or closure.

We are interested specifically in the organisational side of the problem—how responsibilities, information, decisions, coordination and support work when a store requires formal management attention. You are not expected to know confidential DPE procedures. Where actual internal practice is not known, please answer from the DPE context provided and your professional judgement. There are no correct answers.

Definition used in this form: “Serious underperformance” means sustained store-performance problems significant enough for DPE to review the store formally and decide whether recovery support or another course of action is required.

Please enter your name *

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Jerry Chen

Q1. From an organisational perspective, what do you see as the hardest challenge for DPE *
when a franchise store has been seriously underperforming for some time?

The hardest challenge is separating the real causes from visible symptoms while coordinating DPE support with franchisee accountability. A store can underperform because of local demand, unit economics, operational execution, capability or several factors at once. DPE would need timely shared evidence, a named case owner and clear escalation rights, while still respecting franchisee autonomy and acting before the situation deteriorates further.

Q2. Based on the DPE context available to you, how would you expect a case of confirmed serious franchise-store underperformance to be managed? Please briefly outline the main steps you would expect, from understanding the problem through to recovery or, where recovery is not viable, another formal decision. *

Based on the public context, I would expect: (1) a sustained performance trigger and formal case owner; (2) a joint fact-finding review with the franchisee to validate financial, customer and operational data; (3) root-cause diagnosis covering local market, unit economics, people/capability, service execution and compliance; (4) a root-cause-linked recovery plan with owners, DPE support, milestones, measurable outcomes and escalation rules; (5) regular monitoring plus formal review gates; and (6) a governed decision to continue, revise or close recovery, or consider transfer, refranchising or closure if recovery is not viable. This is professional judgement, not a claim about DPE's internal procedure.

Q3. Before recovery actions are agreed, what information would you expect DPE to examine to understand the main causes of the store's underperformance? Please identify the two or three areas you consider most important. *

Three areas: (1) store unit economics and trend—sales/transactions, food and labour costs, delivery costs, margins and cash constraints; (2) operational execution and capability—staffing/rosters, training, product quality, availability, service/delivery times, complaints and customer measures; and (3) local market and governance—catchment demand, competition, pricing/promotions, franchisee engagement, compliance and ability to fund or lead the recovery.

Q4. In your opinion, what should a strong recovery plan for an underperforming franchise store include? Please select up to three elements you consider most important. *

- ☒ Corrective actions that are explicitly linked to the causes identified
- ☒ Clear accountability for each agreed action
- ☐ Time-bound milestones or deadlines
- ☒ Measurable criteria for what successful recovery looks like
- ☐ The DPE support or resources required to carry out the actions
- ☐ A defined review point and escalation rule if performance does not improve
- ☐ Other:

Q5. If inconsistency or breakdown were occurring within the recovery process, at which stage would you investigate first? *

- ☐ Diagnosing the main causes of underperformance
- ☐ Translating the diagnosis into a clear recovery plan
- ☒ Executing the agreed recovery actions and mobilising support
- ☐ Monitoring progress and deciding whether to continue, revise, escalate or close the case
- ☐ No single stage stands out; it would depend on the case
- ☐ Not enough information to judge

Q6. What is the main reason you selected that stage or response? *

I would investigate execution first because that is where a sound diagnosis and plan must become coordinated action. Missing owners, insufficient support, delayed tasks or inconsistent store adoption can make a valid plan appear ineffective. Checking implementation fidelity and resource mobilisation helps distinguish a bad diagnosis from a good plan that was not actually carried out.

Q7. At a planned review point, the store has not improved as expected. Which immediate management response would you consider most appropriate? *

- ☐ Continue the current recovery plan unchanged for more time
- ☒ Reassess the evidence and causes before deciding the next action
- ☐ Revise the recovery actions using the current diagnosis
- ☐ Escalate directly to a governed alternative decision such as refranchising, transfer or closure
- ☐ Not enough information to decide

Q8. If diagnosis, recovery-plan design, execution or follow-up are handled inconsistently between cases, how much impact would you expect this to have on each outcome below? *

Please select one response for each row.

	No material impact	Small impact	Moderate impact	Large impact	Not sure
Time required to reach a clear formal outcome	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐
Likelihood of achieving sustainable recovery	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐
Amount of rework or repeated changes to recovery actions	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐
Risk that performance deteriorates before a clear resolution is reached	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐

Q9. Based on the process you have considered, how plausible do you find the following explanation? *

“Inconsistent diagnosis, recovery-plan design, execution or follow-up materially contributes to some cases taking longer to resolve or failing to achieve sustainable recovery.”

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very implausible	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Very plausible

Q10. What is the main reason for your rating? Please mention anything that makes this explanation more or less convincing in your view. *

The explanation is convincing because inconsistency breaks the chain between evidence, action, ownership and review. Different diagnoses or review rules can create delay, rework and unclear accountability. I rated it 4 rather than 5 because organisational inconsistency is not the only cause: weak local demand, unsustainable unit economics, external shocks or franchisee capability may remain decisive even with a well-controlled intervention process.

Q11. If DPE could investigate only one organisational area first, which would you prioritise as the most plausible contributor to unresolved franchise-store underperformance? *

- ☐ Governance & decision rights – ownership, escalation and decision authority
- ☐ Performance information & detection – timeliness, reliability and shared visibility of early warning
- ☒ Intervention process & control – diagnosis, recovery planning, execution and follow-up
- ☐ Capability & capacity – skills, time, staffing and access to specialist support
- ☐ Not enough information to prioritise

Q12. What is the main reason for your choice? If another area would be a close second, you may mention it briefly. *

I would prioritise intervention process and control because it connects detection to a decision and then to measurable action. A common stage-gated process can reduce variation, make handoffs visible and show whether recovery is working. Governance and decision rights are a close second, because the named case owner must also have authority to obtain support and escalate.

Q13. If you were the senior executive accountable for this process and could make only one *
organisational change first, what would you change, and why?

Introduce one stage-gated Franchise Recovery Case Playbook with a named case owner. Each case would use a common diagnostic data pack, a root-cause-linked action plan, named owners and support, a weekly action/evidence log, formal review gates and predetermined escalation rights. This would reduce avoidable variation and rework, speed decisions and create comparable learning while preserving judgement for case-specific conditions.

Q14. Is there anything else about the organisational causes of franchise-store underperformance, or the way these cases are managed, that you think we should have asked about?

The process should also test franchisee incentives, willingness and trust, DPE support capacity, and data quality. I would explicitly distinguish three situations: the diagnosis was wrong, the plan was appropriate but poorly executed, or the store economics are not recoverable. Otherwise the organisation may redesign the plan repeatedly when the real issue is implementation or viability.

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Harneet Singh

Q1. From an organisational perspective, what do you see as the hardest challenge for DPE *
when a franchise store has been seriously underperforming for some time?

I think the hardest challenge would be balancing support for the franchisee with the need to step in when underperformance becomes serious. DPE would need to make sure there is clear responsibility for who is monitoring the store, who is working with the franchisee, and when the issue should be escalated. If those roles or decision points are unclear, different people could have different views on how serious the problem is or what action should be taken, which could delay the response.

Q2. Based on the DPE context available to you, how would you expect a case of confirmed serious franchise-store underperformance to be managed? Please briefly outline the main steps you would expect, from understanding the problem through to recovery or, where recovery is not viable, another formal decision. *

I would expect DPE to first confirm the extent and causes of the underperformance using store performance information and input from the franchisee. From there, the relevant Franchise Consultant or Market Manager would likely work with the franchisee to agree on a recovery plan, with clear actions, responsibilities and timeframes. The store's progress would then be monitored against that plan, with additional support or escalation if performance did not improve. If the store continued to underperform despite reasonable recovery efforts, I would expect the case to be reviewed by more senior management to decide on the most appropriate formal outcome, such as a transfer, refranchising or closure.

Q3. Before recovery actions are agreed, what information would you expect DPE to examine to understand the main causes of the store's underperformance? Please identify the two or three areas you consider most important. *

I'd focus on three areas: store performance trends like sales and profitability, operational issues such as staffing and service quality, and franchisee or management factors. Together, these should give DPE a clearer idea of what is actually driving the underperformance.

Q4. In your opinion, what should a strong recovery plan for an underperforming franchise store include? Please select up to three elements you consider most important. *

- ☒ Corrective actions that are explicitly linked to the causes identified
- ☐ Clear accountability for each agreed action
- ☒ Time-bound milestones or deadlines
- ☐ Measurable criteria for what successful recovery looks like
- ☐ The DPE support or resources required to carry out the actions
- ☒ A defined review point and escalation rule if performance does not improve
- ☐ Other:

Q5. If inconsistency or breakdown were occurring within the recovery process, at which stage would you investigate first? *

- ☒ Diagnosing the main causes of underperformance
- ☐ Translating the diagnosis into a clear recovery plan
- ☐ Executing the agreed recovery actions and mobilising support
- ☐ Monitoring progress and deciding whether to continue, revise, escalate or close the case
- ☐ No single stage stands out; it would depend on the case
- ☐ Not enough information to judge

Q6. What is the main reason you selected that stage or response? *

Because if the cause is diagnosed incorrectly, the recovery plan will probably target the wrong issues. I'd check this stage first to make sure DPE actually understands what is driving the underperformance before looking further down the process.

Q7. At a planned review point, the store has not improved as expected. Which immediate management response would you consider most appropriate? *

- ☐ Continue the current recovery plan unchanged for more time
- ☐ Reassess the evidence and causes before deciding the next action
- ☒ Revise the recovery actions using the current diagnosis
- ☐ Escalate directly to a governed alternative decision such as refranchising, transfer or closure
- ☐ Not enough information to decide

Q8. If diagnosis, recovery-plan design, execution or follow-up are handled inconsistently between cases, how much impact would you expect this to have on each outcome below? *

Please select one response for each row.

	No material impact	Small impact	Moderate impact	Large impact	Not sure
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Amount of rework or repeated changes to recovery actions	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐
Risk that performance deteriorates before a clear resolution is reached	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐

Q9. Based on the process you have considered, how plausible do you find the following explanation? *

“Inconsistent diagnosis, recovery-plan design, execution or follow-up materially contributes to some cases taking longer to resolve or failing to achieve sustainable recovery.”

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very implausible	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	Very plausible

Q10. What is the main reason for your rating? Please mention anything that makes this explanation more or less convincing in your view. *

I rated it a 5 because inconsistency at any stage could easily delay recovery or lead to the wrong actions being taken. If the problem is diagnosed differently, the plan is unclear, or follow-up is inconsistent, it would be much harder to get a sustained improvement across stores.

Q11. If DPE could investigate only one organisational area first, which would you prioritise as the most plausible contributor to unresolved franchise-store underperformance? *

- ☐ Governance & decision rights – ownership, escalation and decision authority
- ☐ Performance information & detection – timeliness, reliability and shared visibility of early warning
- ☒ Intervention process & control – diagnosis, recovery planning, execution and follow-up
- ☐ Capability & capacity – skills, time, staffing and access to specialist support
- ☐ Not enough information to prioritise

Q12. What is the main reason for your choice? If another area would be a close second, you may mention it briefly. *

I chose intervention process and control because even if DPE identifies the problem correctly, recovery can still fail if the plan, execution or follow-up is inconsistent. Governance and decision rights would probably be my second choice, especially if it is unclear who owns the case or when it should be escalated.

Q13. If you were the senior executive accountable for this process and could make only one organisational change first, what would you change, and why? *

I would introduce one clear and consistent recovery process for all seriously underperforming stores, with defined responsibilities, actions, timeframes and escalation points. That would make it easier to manage cases consistently and reduce the chance of issues being missed or dragging on.

Q14. Is there anything else about the organisational causes of franchise-store underperformance, or the way these cases are managed, that you think we should have asked about?

One thing I would also look at is whether franchisees are actually willing and able to follow the recovery plan. Even with a good process, limited engagement, capability or communication between DPE and the franchisee could still make recovery difficult.

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Dhruv Sachdeva

Q1. From an organisational perspective, what do you see as the hardest challenge for DPE *
when a franchise store has been seriously underperforming for some time?

The hardest challenge is identifying the real cause of the underperformance early enough and making sure the right people take responsibility for fixing it. If diagnosis, accountability or communication are unclear, the recovery process can become slow and inconsistent.

Q2. Based on the DPE context available to you, how would you expect a case of confirmed serious franchise-store underperformance to be managed? Please briefly outline the main steps you would expect, from understanding the problem through to recovery or, where recovery is not viable, another formal decision. *

I would expect DPE to first review the store's financial and operational performance, identify the main causes of underperformance, and discuss the findings with the franchisee and relevant support teams. A recovery plan should then be created with clear actions, responsibilities, targets and review dates. Progress should be monitored regularly. If the store does not improve, DPE should reassess the causes and consider stronger actions such as refranchising, transfer or closure.

Q3. Before recovery actions are agreed, what information would you expect DPE to examine to understand the main causes of the store's underperformance? Please identify the two or three areas you consider most important. *

I would focus on store financial performance, operational performance such as sales, customer service and labour efficiency, and local market conditions including competition and customer demand. Franchisee capability and compliance with operating standards would also be important.

Q4. In your opinion, what should a strong recovery plan for an underperforming franchise store include? Please select up to three elements you consider most important. *

- ☒ Corrective actions that are explicitly linked to the causes identified
- ☒ Clear accountability for each agreed action
- ☐ Time-bound milestones or deadlines
- ☒ Measurable criteria for what successful recovery looks like
- ☐ The DPE support or resources required to carry out the actions
- ☐ A defined review point and escalation rule if performance does not improve
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Q5. If inconsistency or breakdown were occurring within the recovery process, at which stage would you investigate first? *

- ☒ Diagnosing the main causes of underperformance
- ☐ Translating the diagnosis into a clear recovery plan
- ☐ Executing the agreed recovery actions and mobilising support
- ☐ Monitoring progress and deciding whether to continue, revise, escalate or close the case
- ☐ No single stage stands out; it would depend on the case
- ☐ Not enough information to judge

Q6. What is the main reason you selected that stage or response? *

If the initial diagnosis is inaccurate or incomplete, the recovery plan may focus on the wrong problems. This can lead to wasted effort, repeated changes and delays even if the later stages are managed properly.

Q7. At a planned review point, the store has not improved as expected. Which immediate management response would you consider most appropriate? *

- ☐ Continue the current recovery plan unchanged for more time
- ☒ Reassess the evidence and causes before deciding the next action
- ☐ Revise the recovery actions using the current diagnosis
- ☐ Escalate directly to a governed alternative decision such as refranchising, transfer or closure
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Q8. If diagnosis, recovery-plan design, execution or follow-up are handled inconsistently between cases, how much impact would you expect this to have on each outcome below? *

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Q9. Based on the process you have considered, how plausible do you find the following explanation? *

“Inconsistent diagnosis, recovery-plan design, execution or follow-up materially contributes to some cases taking longer to resolve or failing to achieve sustainable recovery.”

	1	2	3	4	5	
Very implausible	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	Very plausible

Q10. What is the main reason for your rating? Please mention anything that makes this explanation more or less convincing in your view. *

A recovery process depends on consistent diagnosis, planning, execution and review. If these stages are handled differently between cases, important causes may be missed, responsibilities may become unclear and decisions may be delayed. This makes sustainable recovery less likely and increases the chance of repeated corrective actions.

Q11. If DPE could investigate only one organisational area first, which would you prioritise as the most plausible contributor to unresolved franchise-store underperformance? *

- ☐ Governance & decision rights – ownership, escalation and decision authority
- ☐ Performance information & detection – timeliness, reliability and shared visibility of early warning
- ☒ Intervention process & control – diagnosis, recovery planning, execution and follow-up
- ☐ Capability & capacity – skills, time, staffing and access to specialist support
- ☐ Not enough information to prioritise

Q12. What is the main reason for your choice? If another area would be a close second, you may mention it briefly. *

The intervention process connects diagnosis, action and monitoring. If this process is inconsistent, even good performance information may not lead to effective action. Governance and decision rights would be a close second because clear escalation and accountability are also important.

Q13. If you were the senior executive accountable for this process and could make only one organisational change first, what would you change, and why? *

I would introduce a standardised recovery framework for all seriously underperforming stores. It should define how problems are diagnosed, who is responsible for each action, what success measures are used, and when escalation is required. This would improve consistency, accountability and decision making across cases.

Q14. Is there anything else about the organisational causes of franchise-store underperformance, or the way these cases are managed, that you think we should have asked about?

It may also be useful to ask how feedback from previous recovery cases is captured and shared across the franchise network. Lessons from successful and unsuccessful interventions could help DPE improve future recovery decisions.

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